

IAN GABRIEL C. SANTILLAN

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VOLUNTEER AND WORK EXPERIENCE

NCHU Systematics and Morphology Laboratory

Taichung, Taiwan

Intern

May - August 2024

- Measured key morphometrics for paratypes and holotype specimens of undescribed Reduviidae
- Prepared and photographed specimens for publication
- Examined deposited paratypes of Subfamily Ectrichodiinae for comparative morphology
- Published a description of a new micropterous species of Reduviid from Vietnam

NCHU Molecular Biology and Systematics Laboratory

Taichung, Taiwan

Laboratory Exchange

February - August 2024

- Collected insect specimens from subtropical montane areas in Taiwan using sweep net and leaf litter samples
- Organized and identified up to morphospecies Psyllidae specimens collected from 2007-2015 in Mt. Xushan in Taiwan
- Prepared samples for gel electrophoresis and genetic sequencing using COI, 16s, and Cyt b primers

NCHU Insect Collections Museum

Taichung, Taiwan

Intern

May - August 2024

- Organized and sorted specimens from family Chrysomelidae in Taiwan into subfamilies and morphospecies

UPLB Cave Ecology Laboratory

Los Baños, Laguna

Museum Volunteer

August - October 2023

- Maintained insect collections from various field surveys
- Sorted collected specimens to various insect orders
- Assisted in updating checklist of collected specimens from different field surveys

UPLB Museum of Natural History Mycological Herbarium

Los Baños, Laguna

Museum Volunteer

April - August 2023

- Assisted in updating herbarium database
- Helped check and catalog collection data of lichens and macrofungi
- Took photographs of representative species of birds in the Rabor Wildlife Collections

UPLB College of Arts and Sciences Student Council	Los Baños, Laguna
Councilor and Community Rights and Welfare (CRAW) Head	2022 - 2023
Freshman Representative & Students' Rights and Welfare Head	2021- 2022
• Handled course petitions for BS Biology students • Represented the CAS Student Council at on-ground mobilizations • Wrote alerts and statements on national and local issues • Spearheaded a biodiversity discussion and nature contact event at Mt. Makiling, Laguna	

Ateneo de Davao University SHS Peer Tutorials Program	Davao City, Davao del Sur
General Biology Head Tutor	2020-2021
• Tutored peers in General Biology 7 hours per week • Helped student with homework and activities • Conducted semesterly video conferences as preparation for exams	

Marine Science Institute Biological Oceanography and Modeling of Ecosystem Laboratory	Remote
Remote Extern	2020
• Created ecological models using satellite data with Dr. Aletta Yñiguez • Cleaned marine occurrence data from various repositories	

Student Publications	Davao City, Davao del Sur
Associate Editor-in-Chief and News Editor for <i>Ang Tulay</i>	2019 - 2021
News Editor for <i>Ang Galawdiwa</i>	2018 - 2019
News Editor for <i>The Movers</i>	2016 - 2018
• Spearheaded online integration of publication during the quarantine (16k+ hits) • Covered school events and activities • Review and revised articles for publication	

PROJECTS AND EVENTS

PLAYGROUND: Escape 2 Euphoria Party	Herbal Hot Spring Resort, Laguna
Consultant for Publicity and Marketing	November 2024
• Advised on marketing strategy and publicity design for an event attended by ~900–1000 people • Coordinated sponsorships and promotional campaigns, including securing Demi, a Filipino singer, as guest performer to increase ticket sales	

Gentong Ani: Community Project

Alfonso, Laguna

Project Head

November 2023

- Conducted a community immersion with the Kaysuyo Farmers Association from November 11–12
- Partnered with the Bureau of Plant Industry to donate vegetable seeds, mushroom seeding bags, and fertilizers
- Conducted a capacity-building seminar on sustainable agriculture and post-harvest processing

PLAYGROUND: Not For Kids Party

Herbal Hot Spring Resort, Laguna

Publicity and Marketing Head

November 2023

- Directed creation of publicity materials including teaser videos, posters, DJ reveal, and sponsorship packages for an event attended by ~800 people
- Organized ticket bundles, promos, and marketing campaigns to boost audience engagement

Likha't Laya: Freshie Welcoming Event

Los Baños, Laguna

Project Co-Head

August 2023

- Co-led the organization of a welcoming event attended by ~500 freshmen, fostering camaraderie and school spirit
- Directed event flow, including a freedom wall painting activity that encouraged creativity and student expression
- Coordinated with sponsors such as Suy Foods to secure event support and resources
- Engaged alumni and guests, including TOYM awardee Fellow Ariestelo Asilo '06, in program participation

Upsilon Sigma Phi February Fair Booth

Los Baños, Laguna

Logistics Committee Head

December 2022 - February 2023

- Handled logistical concerns from materials transport to programs planning
- Assisted in securing booth permits from the University Student Council

UPLB Freshie Week 2021

Los Baños, Laguna

Logistics Committee Head

September 2021

- Lead the drafting and sending of letters to partners and sponsors for the event

Upcycle MindaNOW Conference and Community Food Gardens

Tagum City, Philippines

Executive Director and Founder

September 2020 - February 2021

- Partnered with 20+ Organizations and Schools, including NatGeo and UNESCO
- Distributed ~100 upcycling kits to community food gardens in Mindanao

- Impacted 1,200+ individuals online through social media metrics
- Raised PHP 14,000 in donations and sponsorships

Sparks Labs Podcast

Remote

Co-Host

September - December 2020

- Planned and coordinated interviews with possible speakers
- Interviewed scientists and graduate students from Harvard University, Columbia University and University of Texas Austin
- Collaborated with students from the United States, Kenya, Pakistan, Philippines, and the Caribbean

EDUCATION

National Chung Hsing University

Taichung, Taiwan

BS Entomology Exchange Student

February - June 2024

- 4.075 GPA

University of the Philippines Los Baños

Los Baños, Laguna

BS Biology, Major in Systematics

2021 - Present

Thesis title: Taxonomic Review of Micropterous
Haematoloecha Stål 1874 (Hemiptera: Heteroptera:
Reduviidae.

Ateneo de Davao University Senior High School

Davao City, Davao del Sur

STEM Pre-Science Track

2019 - 2021

- With Honors
- Fr. George Lemaitre S.J. Award for Best Research

Tagum City National High School

Tagum City, Davao del Norte

STEM Curriculum

2015 - 2019

- 2019 National Science Schools Press Conference, Finalist
- 2018 & 2019 National Science Quest, Finalist
- 2018, Regional Science and Technology Fair, Finalist

PUBLICATIONS

Santillan, IGC. (2020). *A Low-Cost Prototype Classroom Attendance Checker and Logger Using Facial Recognition*. Young Scientists Journal.

Santillan, IGC. & Rédei, D. (2025). *A new micropterous species of Haematoloecha from Vietnam (Hemiptera: Heteroptera: Reduviidae)*. Zootaxa 5575 (2): 295–304.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATES

Search Engine Optimization (SEO) I Certification

HubSpot Academy
July 2025 - August 2026

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Proficiencies

- Journalistic and Statement Writing
- Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, Powerpoint)
- Publication and Social Media Management
- Graphic Design on Canva
- HTML, Python, R, QGIS
- WordPress, Elementor
- Capcut, Davinci Resolve